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God's Plans and Purposes

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God's Plans and Purposes

"We now have this light shining in our hearts, but we ourselves are like fragile clay jars containing this great treasure. This makes it clear that our great power is from God, not from ourselves." (2 Corinthians 4:7, NLT)

It is critical to understand that what we are talking about here is a work that is being done by God, and not by us. The Bible tells us: "God is always on the move in the ever changing circumstances of this world. He is also at work in each one of us" (NIV).

The apostle Paul wrote, "He [Jesus] gave his life to free us from every kind of sin, to cleanse us, and to make us his very own people, totally committed to doing good deeds" (Titus 2:14, NLT). God has created us, designed us, *and* given us various capacities for doing the good works that he has prepared for us to do. It is a contradiction in terms to be a Converterlator and not being out there as an agent of change.

For me personally, when I think of what salvation has accomplished, I am *compelled* to be a Converterlator, actively doing whatever I can do to help advance the kingdom of God. Think about these two passages of Scripture:

Giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in light. He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son, in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins. (Colossians 1:12-14, ESV)

Wow! God has *qualified us* to share in *all* of the benefits of having a *relationship* with him both now and forever. As I understand what all of that means, I really get excited about what God has done, and what he is doing. God has also *delivered us* from the domain of darkness, the hopeless state or condition of our sin that held us captive under the dominion of the Chief Consumerlator. God has *freed us* from that awful state, and *transferred us* to the kingdom of his Son, granting us access to the transforming promises of God. We are freed now so that we can be Converterlators, changing the eternal destinies of people, building treasure in heaven, and leveraging time, talent, and treasure for the imperishable values of heaven.

As we seek to accomplish God's purposes, it is important to stay focused on God's plans. As we converterlate our resources we need to be careful not to play to the applause of the world. It is easy to be swayed by the praise of those around us, even as we seek to do God's will. The temptation is always out there to be involved in the more visible types of spiritual endeavors, such as making an effort to be in more prominent positions of leadership, or giving our money in places where our donations will be publicly recognized. However, we must stay focused on God's ultimate plans and desires.

One of my goals as a practitioner of *KingdomNomics* is to be a low-profile, high-impact Converterlator for helping to fulfill the Great Commission. I want to have a low profile so as to not draw unnecessary attention, but I want to be making a big impact! Think about a soccer team or a football team. Each player is most significant when they are fulfilling the role they were designed for. In order to win, each player must play in the position he has been assigned. You are the most significant and have the most impact when you are faithfully filling the position on the team where the coach has placed you.

In what way are you engaged in God's plans and purposes?

Converterlators remain focused on God's plans and purposes.

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Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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